or in some other similar way. He was a Savior as no one else

genuineness of some of the greatest eschatological prophecies has been the feeling that the ideas of free grace and supernatural transformation, so prominent in them, are out of keeping with the intensely ethical spirit of the prophets. It is nothing else but the Pelagian view of religion seeking to dislodge the Augustinian view from its double stronghold in prophecy and Gospel. But practically all this anti-soteric effort can have but one result. It is bound to raise an unsurmountable barrier between the historical Jesus and the refusers of his supreme gift. As He is entirely and every moment intent upon thus imparting Himself, every communion assumed to be operating on an other, unsoteric, basis is a pseudo-communion, impossible on psychological grounds alone.

Lastly the Messianic consciousness is most intimately interwoven with the specifically religious position the Messiah occupies between God and man. It includes at bottom his right to receive worship and his identification with God. These

[6] Wagner in *Z. f. N. T. W.*, 1905.

highest of claims are inseparable from it. To be sure, it must be acknowledged that at this point the conjunction of the one with the other is of a somewhat different nature than in the case of the ingredients previously examined. There the conception of Messiahship, analytically considered, of itself yielded the elements in question. The title to deity and consequent worship are not given with the Messiahship as such. In the abstract a type of Messiahship is conceivable that could dispense with them. In the Messiah construed after the Jewish pattern, a royal leader and conqueror in the conflict with the pagan power, and subsequently the peace-bringing regent over the people of God, there is nothing postulating deity or reception of worship from those over whom He is appointed. His position would be close to God, but it would at every point in his career, even the highest, remain distinctly marked off from the prerogatives of the Godhead as such. But we are not dealing with Messiahship in the abstract. Our concern is with that specific type of the office which is present in the consciousness of Jesus. Here the indispensableness of strictly divine prerogatives in order to the adequate exercise of its functions springs into view. This is due to the thorough spiritualizing the idea has undergone in the mind of Jesus. So long as the Messiah's task is conceived as lying in the sphere of external, national, earthly kingship and salvation it remains possible to regard Him as the representative of God without investing Him with divine attributes. But when his function comes to lie in the sphere of spiritual relationship to God, in those high regions where God touches the soul and the soul touches God, then his calling immediately places Him in the center of the field where the forces of religion play.

59. Ἦραν οὖν λίθους ἵνα βάλωσιν ἐπ' αὐτόν· Ἰησοῦς δὲ ἐκρύβη καὶ ἐξῆλθεν ἐκ τοῦ ἱεροῦ.

form of affirmation (see on 1^{51}) twice before in this discourse, at vv. 34, 51; and in each case, as here, it sums up what has gone before.

πρὶν Ἀβραὰμ γενέσθαι ἐγὼ εἰμί, *i.e.* "before Abraham came into being, I AM." The contrast betweeen the verbs γίγνεσθαι and εἶναι is as unmistakable as it is in Ps. 90^{2}, πρὸ τοῦ ὄρη γενηθῆναι . . . ἀπὸ τοῦ αἰῶνος ἕως τοῦ αἰῶνος σὺ εἶ, "before the mountains came into being . . . from age to age THOU ART."[1] Of God it could not be said that He "came into being" or "became," for He IS. Cf. 1^{18} and Col. 1^{17} for this absolute use of εἶναι; see also on 1^{1}. It has been pointed out already (see Introd., p. cxxi) that ἐγὼ εἰμί used absolutely, where no predicate is expressed or implied, is the equivalent of the solemn אֲנִי־הוּא, *I (am) He*, which is the self-designation of Yahweh in the prophets. A similar use of the phrase is found at 13^{19}. It is clear that Jn. means to represent Jesus as thus claiming for Himself the timeless being of Deity, as distinct from the temporal existence of man. This is the teaching of the Prologue to the Gospel about Jesus ($1^{1.\ 18}$); but here (and at 13^{19}) Jesus Himself is reported as having said *I (am) He*, which is a definite assertion of His Godhead, and was so understood by the Jews. They had listened to His argument up to this point; but they could bear with it no longer. These words of mystery were rank blasphemy (see 10^{33}), and they proceeded to stone Him.

For other occurrences in Jn. of ἐγὼ εἰμί without a predicate following, see 6^{20} 9^{9} 18^{6}, as well as vv. 24, 28 of the present chapter.

The angry people would stone Jesus, but He escapes from them into hiding (v. 59)

59. ἦραν οὖν λίθους κτλ. So again at 10^{31-33}, when He said "I and the Father are One," the Jews attempted to

31. Ἐβάστασαν πάλιν λίθους οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι ἵνα λιθάσωσιν αὐτόν. 32. ἀπεκρίθη αὐτοῖς ὁ Ἰησοῦς Πολλὰ ἔργα ἔδειξα ὑμῖν καλὰ ἐκ τοῦ Πατρός· διὰ ποῖον αὐτῶν ἔργον ἐμὲ λιθάζετε; 33. ἀπεκρίθησαν αὐτῷ

to ἕν ἐσμεν in 1 Cor. 3^8, where Paul says ὁ φυτεύων καὶ ὁ ποτίζων ἕν εἰσιν, meaning that both the "planter" and the "waterer" of the seed are in the same category, as compared with God who gives the increase. A unity of fellowship, of will, and of purpose between the Father and the Son is a frequent theme in the Fourth Gospel (cf. $5^{18.\ 19}$ $14^{9.\ 23}$ and $17^{11.\ 22}$), and it is tersely and powerfully expressed here; but to press the words so as to make them indicate identity of οὐσία, is to introduce thoughts which were not present to the theologians of the first century.

Ignatius expresses the same thought as that conveyed in this verse, when he writes ὁ κύριος ἄνευ τοῦ πατρὸς οὐδὲν ἐποίησεν, ἡνωμένος ὤν (*Magn.* 7). Cf. 8^{28} above.

The Jews accuse Jesus of blasphemy: He defends His claim to be Son of God (*vv.* 31–39)

31. The Jewish opponents of Jesus, with a true instinct, perceived that He was claiming to be more than human.

ἐβάστασαν πάλιν (cf. 8^{59}) **λίθους οἱ Ἰουδ. κτλ.** For βαστάζειν, see on 12^6 below. Here it means "to lift up and carry off," and expresses more than αἴρειν in the similar context in 8^{59}. They fetched stones from a distance, that they might stone Him. The verb λιθάζειν does not occur in the Synoptists, but cf. 11^8.

32. ἀπεκρ. αὐτοῖς ὁ Ἰη. He did not withdraw Himself immediately, as at 8^{59}, but proceeded to answer the thoughts which urged them to kill Him. Cf. 5^{17} and Mk. 11^{14} for ἀπεκρίνεσθαι used of an answer to acts, rather than to words.

πολλὰ ἔργα καλά, "many noble works," καλός expressing goodness as well as beauty (see on 10^{11} and cf. 1 Tim. 6^{18}). His